Sony senses a market in ESP

Richard Lloyd Parry Tokyo
Thursday 12 October 1995 00:02 BST

Comments

outsystems
Your support helps us to tell the story
Build your agentic future
Read more
SUPPORT NOW
Read more

RICHARD LLOYD PARRY

Tokyo

After persuading the world to retreat into the private universe of the Walkman, Sony is going one step further: it has disclosed that it is branching out into the paranormal. The Japanese corporation, the leading innovator in consumer electronics, admits it is researching into alternative medicine, spoon-bending, X-ray vision, telepathy and other forms of extra- sensory perception (ESP).

The Sony "Institute of Wisdom" was founded in 1989 at the instigation of the company's founder, Masaharu Ibuka, and Akio Morita, its charismatic former chairman. The company believes it has proved the existence of ESP, and is considering the possibility of machines that would enable us to communicate telepathically - the Sony Spookman, as it is likely to be known.

"Mr Ibuka and Mr Morita have long felt that there's more to science and technology than what is repeatable, universal and objective," a spokeswoman said. "Some people have the ability to perceive beyond the five senses. This research is intended to investigate how this happens and why."

A sub-division of the Institute, Extra-Sensory Perception Excitation Research (Esper), has worked with more than 100 possessors of ESP. Subjects were presented with two black plastic containers, one of them containing platinum, the other empty. Psychic individuals were able to "see" the platinum seven times out of 10. Much of the research focuses on the mysterious spiritual energy known as ki, which forms the basis of a great deal of traditional oriental medicine.

The company has already devised one product, the Pulse Graph, based on a prototype developed by a South Korean holistic doctor. It is claimed to have a 20 to 30 per cent success-rate in diagnosing diseases such as liver cancer.

More about: Cancer Media Pharmaceuticals Sony

Join our commenting forum
Join thought-provoking conversations, follow other Independent readers and see their replies
Comments

Promoted stories

Here's The Average Gutter Price For a 1500 Sq Ft House
Thanks to this smart gutter upgrade its never been easier to prevent clogs and water damage and keep your home protected year-round.
Sponsored | HOMEBUDDY.COM Get Quote

Temu Clearance Sale
Temu Clearance Sale, where unbeatable discounts meet your shopping needs
Sponsored | TEMU Shop Now

The Outdoor Decor Military Fans Love
A submarine-inspired wind spinner that adds motion and bold character to any outdoor space.
Sponsored | GRADDI Read More

Renew Your Passport From Home — Here's How.
Trusted by millions for fast, no-hassle passport renewals & application.
Sponsored | GOVPLUS Learn More

Adult E-Bike
48V 720W Power, 50-Mile Range, Hydraulic Brakes for a Smooth Ride

Sponsored | TEMU
Shop Now

How I Finally Fixed Those Floor Gaps
Stop ignoring this floor problem—it's easier to fix than you think.
Sponsored | ESSLYN FLOORMATE
Learn More

Garden Savings on Temu
Unbeatable Prices on Garden Essentials
Sponsored | TEMU
Shop Now

ER Doctor: "I Threw Out Every Pan After What I Found in My Kitchen"
Sponsored | KITCHEN-EXPERTS
Learn More

UK POLITICS

Rob Reiner's oldest son breaks silence on parents' 'horrendous' double murder

RAF fighter jets scrambled to threat of Russian drones on Nato border

Read More Comments

US POLITICS
Megyn Kelly tears into Trump over latest polling: 'You're Effed'

Jill Biden has questions to answer – her husband was not fit to run for a second term
Far be it from me to encourage conspiracy theories, but perhaps Donald Jr is right about Joe Biden's shock cancer diagnosis, says Jon Sopel
Sponsored | PROMOTED BY INDEPENDENT PREMIUM

The Average Cost To Replace Windows In 2026
See why thousands of homeowners are replacing old windows in 2026 for as low as this.
Sponsored | CHAMPION WINDOWS PARTNER
Learn More

Ultra-Soft Henley Shirt Loved by Thousands of Men
The shirt that looks effortlessly cool and feels unbelievably soft — no wonder it's becoming every man's favorite.
Sponsored | WALKERGREY
Shop Now

LIFESTYLE
Man jailed for religiously aggravated rape of Sikh woman after he followed her home

Three supplements to help you exercise in the heat

Dermatologists: The 1 Vitamin You Need If You Have Wrinkles
She stopped using her moisturizer and tried this instead — the results surprised everyone.
Sponsored | ANTI-AGING CENTER
Read More

NEWS
Iran's supreme leader 'gravely wounded' as new report details his injuries